Race Radar— How to Use It

1. Core Concept and Definition

- What is Race Radar
  - A tool that classifies each runner's likely running style based on recent finishing-position patterns.
  - It provides a behavioral read of the race rather than a standard statistics grid.
  - Each runner is assigned a style bar and a specific Win Rate figure.
- Primary Purpose
  - To help bettors understand the likely shape and behavior of the race before placing a bet.
  - Used to picture how the race may unfold in terms of pace and positioning.
- The Race Header
  - Contains essential metadata including course name and race time.
  - Lists technical details such as surface type, distance, and race class.
  - Includes a Going badge to indicate ground conditions.

2. The Three Running Styles

- Win or Bust (Green)
  - Characterized by a high win rate but extreme volatility.
  - The horse typically either wins the race or finishes nowhere near the front.
- Steady (Blue)
  - Represents horses that are consistently near the front of the pack.
  - They are considered reliable performers but may lack a "killer" turn of foot to win every time.
- Erratic (Red)
  - Indicates unpredictable form where finishing positions are inconsistent.
  - These runners finish all over the place, making them difficult to forecast.
- Unknown (Grey)
  - Applied when there are not enough recent runs to provide an accurate classification.
  - Flags a lack of data for the specific runner.

3. Interpreting Runner and Race Data

- Individual Runner Rows
  - Style Bar
    - Visual representation showing the estimated running style and the strength of that tendency.
  - Win Rate Figure
    - Displays the horse's own recent win rate to provide context for the style.
    - Example: A high Win Rate combined with a Win or Bust style suggests a genuine threat when the horse performs well.
    - Example: A Steady style with a modest win rate suggests a horse that may place more often than it wins.
- The Race-Level Tally
  - Summary Counts
    - A tally showing how many runners fall into each style category.
  - Identifying Race Shape
    - Allows for an at-a-glance assessment of the race dynamic.
    - Example: A race with a lone Steady front-runner versus a field of Erratic types sets up differently than a crowded front-runner field.
  - Reliability Check
    - The Unknown count indicates how much of the field is unclassified; a high number of unknowns makes the read less reliable.

4. The Critical 49 Percent Caveat

- Data Limitations
  - Styles are estimated based on a small sample of the last 5 runs, with a minimum of 2 required.
- Persistence Statistics
  - National Hunt (NH) running styles only persist about 49% of the time.
  - This means the classification is roughly a coin-flip to hold true on the actual race day.
- Mindset for Use
  - The tool should be treated as a likely tendency, never a certainty or guarantee.
  - This caveat is the single most important factor to remember when using Race Radar.

5. Strategic Integration and Workflow

- Combining with Other Tools
  - Draw Bias
    - Used to see where stall positions might favor a specific running style.
  - Tissue Pricer
    - While Race Radar explains the shape, the Tissue Pricer identifies the actual price and betting edge.
  - Today's Cards
    - Provides the full runner-by-runner form and broader context.
- Putting it into Action
  - Read the race shape from the tally to find obvious pace setups.
  - Note which styles suit the specific track, trip, and draw of the day.
  - Weight the read by the 49% caveat to avoid over-committing to a single outcome.
  - Size bets sensibly using the Bet Calculator.

6. Common Mistakes and Misconceptions

- Over-Reliance on Style
  - Treating a running style as a fixed certainty rather than a tendency.
  - Backing a Win or Bust type with the expectation that it will fire every time.
- Data Neglect
  - Ignoring the Unknown count which can compromise the reliability of the race shape.
  - Forgetting the small sample size (last 5 runs) behind each classification.
- Functional Errors
  - Using Race Radar as a tipping shortcut instead of a tool for race-shape context.
  - Confusing how a horse runs (style) with whether the horse represents value.

7. Further Reading and Resources

- Tissue Pricer — model's price and edge
- Draw Bias — how stalls interact with running style
- Today's Cards — full runner-by-runner context
- Mispriced: